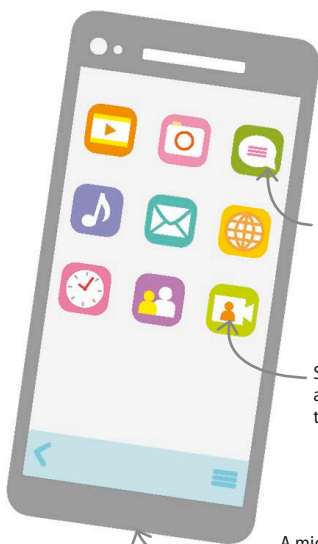


Smartphones and tablets

Perhaps the most popular types of computer, smartphones and tablet computers have changed the way we do just about everything online.

Billions of users

There are more than 2 billion smartphones and 1 billion tablets in active use worldwide. The first smartphone appeared in 1992, with IBM's Simon Personal Computer – a letter box-sized mobile that featured a digital panel. The real revolution in the field was the release of the Apple iPhone in 2007. Apple also released the iPad in 2010, the first tablet computer to prove a hit, though other companies had tried the idea before. Both allow users to run software applications, or apps, to make use of the hardware, and are navigated by using a touchscreen.



Messaging apps may use either cellular networks or the internet.

Smartphones often have an in-built camera that can take video or photographs.

A microphone on the bottom can pick up or record sound.

△ Mobile connectivity

Smartphones are able to send and receive cellular signals, but can also connect to the internet via Wi-Fi, show the phone's GPS location, and connect to other devices over Bluetooth.

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A speaker allows sound to be heard.

Tablets have a much bigger screen than smartphones, which is more suited to watching films and online shopping.

Users touch and drag their fingers on the tablet's touchscreen to navigate.

Some tablets and smartphones feature a fingerprint scanner that unlocks the device when a recognized finger is pressed against it.

△ Bigger and more powerful

Tablets are bigger than smartphones, which makes them less portable. They usually have more processing power than smartphones, and can handle more complex apps.